

Main

Report Name (Org_Country_Year_Report Type)

IRC Somalia_Kenya_2022-23_3-month_report

Fellowship Organization

International Rescue Committee (IRC)

Fellowship City

Nairobi

Fellowship Country

Kenya

Fellowship Start Date

09/01/2022

Anticipated Fellowship End Date

08/31/2023

What is your fellowship title/role?

Grants and Programs Fellow

What are your primary responsibilities?

- Produce weekly Situational Reports on political, security and humanitarian developments that affect the organization's operations and activities
- Draft grant proposals to respond to drought and insecurity through multi-sectoral interventions (governance, protection, peacebuilding, livelihoods, WASH, health and nutrition)
- Liaise with partners, government ministries and field offices to design and implement programs
- Contribute to building a network of local partners by identifying and meeting with local organizations that align with the IRC's strategic goals and priorities
- Assist with management and coordination of day-to-day operations and activities of field offices
- Provide administrative and substantive support for meetings, official visits, and workshops including logistics, preparing background documents and drafting briefing notes

I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.

Agree

Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?

Yes

Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.

Previous PiAf Fellow wrote a handover note and walked me through it before I started

If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?**Describe a representative day at work.**

I generally have a few meetings to review the progress of grants and projects that are being implemented. For some of the meetings I am responsible for preparing briefing notes and introducing the work to the implementation teams. I take notes during meetings and send them out after to all attendees. I am responsible for updating the progress of grants and programs in the internal system and I communicate with whoever is responsible for the current phase to ensure that it has been completed and can move to the next stage. I generally do a few ad-hoc tasks that vary depending on who needs assistance.

On average, how many hours per week do you work?

30-40

How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?

Effective

Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.

I led the drafting of a concept note for a 900,000 USD grant from the Swedish government which included getting inputs from technical coordinators and putting them into the template provided by the donor.

I am currently working on conducting research and finding funding for a climate change resilience project aimed at help farmers and pastoralists adapt their livelihoods to climate change through ecological restoration.

What is your organization's work culture like?**What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.**

I work in the regional office and it is large. It is an open plan workspace with individual and group rooms for meetings. It is a very nice building. I do most of my work at my desk and occasionally work from home.

To whom do you report?

I report to the acting Grants Coordinator and Governance Unit Technical Coordinator. I meet with them to track the progress of grants and contribute to reporting requirements from donors. He also works with me to establish and track the progress of my professional goals during my time at IRC.

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?

Yes

Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.**Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.**

1. Coordinate the start up phase of three grants with progressively less supervision within the next six months
2. Contribute to designing protection programming for three grants demonstrating clear and effective understanding of the sector and how to integrate it with other sectors
3. Assist with designing a monitoring and evaluation plan for at least two grants within six months

How often do you check in with your supervisor?

Weekly

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

No, but it has been discussed

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).**I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.**

Agree

Please briefly explain your response.

I am able to complete the tasks asked of me while asking for help when things are not clear. My supervisor allows me to work independently which helps me learn but is also available when I have questions.

Life at Fellowship Site

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

I purchased my ticket from Denver to Nairobi for ~\$700. I flew United Airlines from Denver to New York and Kenya Airways from NY to Nairobi. I have not booked a return flight.

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

I came with a tourist visa and am applying for a student pass

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

I applied for the tourist visa and IRC is applying for the student pass for me

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

Yes

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

\$50

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

I paid for the first pass

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

No

If yes, please explain further

g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

Apply no more than a week in advance because they send it very quickly

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

I didn't have to get vaccinated. I have not received my yellow fever vaccine yet.

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

My arrival and first week were fine. No recommended improvements

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

I live in the IRC guest house and don't pay rent or utilities.

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Very Urban

Please describe your living environment

I live west of the city center in a very central and busy location. I have easy access to a shopping center that generally has the things I need. I enjoy the location.

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

I take a taxi to and from work that is provided by IRC

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

I live in an urban area

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

The weather is very nice. Usually sunny and 70s although it is the rainy season so it rains a few times a week. It is currently summer.

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

I dress casually to work, generally a t-shirt and jeans which is appropriate pretty much everywhere.

How have you been spending your free time?

I spend time with other fellows and some friends I have made going to restaurants, bars, markets and cafes. There are lots of opportunities for socializing.

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response below.

I communicate regularly with my friends and family back home and try to make sure that I do at least one social event a week.

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

My neighborhood is generally safe during the day but Nairobi is not safe at night. There is lots of petty crime and violent crime has spiked recently across the city.

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

I do not walk outside at night and never show my phone or wallet when walking around outside.

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

No experiences with crime.

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

There is lots of petty crime in Nairobi. I recommend living in Kilimani, Kileleshwa, Lavington, or Westlands.

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

I do not remember the goals I set during orientation

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

It should be made clear that the guest house where fellows live is considered a common area and strangers will be coming and going frequently.

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

No

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

I exercise and make sure I am socializing with people I enjoy to take care of my mental health.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

People stare at me everywhere I go.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

The homophobia and class/race based separation between expats and the local people.

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

I miss not having regular power outages, being able to drink from the tap, and being able to be openly gay.

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

The culture seems more laid back. Americans have internalized capitalism and base their worth on their productivity. Kenyans are more patient.

How is your stipend being paid?

The stipend is paid monthly in USD to my US account

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

Wire

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

No, I continued a part-time consultancy with an NGO based in Sudan but forgot to tell PiAf.

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$50.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$30.00	\$0.00	\$50.00	\$350.00	\$0.00	\$50.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	480.00
Specify "Other"					

Final Thoughts

PiAf's orientation was sufficient in preparing me to transition into my fellowship.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

The orientation was comprehensive and prepared me well.

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

No recommendations

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)

No recommendations.